

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 5

Chapter 13: The Story of Indian Farming

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	13 — The Story of Indian Farming
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct.

Apex traps: classification axes are independent and stack (purpose = subsistence/commercial; effort-per-area = intensive/extensive; water = rain-fed/irrigated; season = kharif/rabi/zaid) so a single farm carries several labels at once; the Green Revolution's gains and harms are CAUSALLY linked through the same intensive inputs, not separate; rabi lives in the dry winter and usually needs irrigation while kharif rides the southwest monsoon (Jun-Sep) and the northeast monsoon (Oct-Dec) only soaks the southeast; women do most hands-on field work yet are undercounted as unpaid family labour; organic/sustainable farming CUTS chemicals without abandoning food; hydroponics proves soil is not strictly required; antiquity (7th-8th millennium BCE rice) shows continuity, not a foreign or modern origin. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A grower works a single hectare with heavy hand labour, pumps water from her own tube well, keeps the entire grain harvest to feed her household, and sells nothing. Counting every independent classification axis the chapter uses, how many of the labels intensive, subsistence and irrigated correctly apply to her at the same time?

- (A) Only intensive, since a farm can carry just one label at a time
- (B) Only subsistence, because purpose overrides every other description
- (C) All three, because effort-per-area, purpose, and water source are independent axes that each describe a real feature of her farm
- (D) None, because a farmer who sells nothing cannot be described by farming terms at all

2. Farmer A spreads light effort across a large dry holding for a low yield per hectare and sells all the grain; Farmer B pours labour and irrigation into a small plot for a high yield per hectare and eats it all. Which single pair of contrasts between A and B is stated correctly?

- (A) A is extensive and commercial, while B is intensive and subsistence
- (B) A is intensive and subsistence, while B is extensive and commercial
- (C) A is extensive and subsistence, while B is intensive and commercial
- (D) Both are commercial because both clearly produce a crop

3. Over five years one unchanged field is labelled, in order, subsistence, commercial, commercial, subsistence, commercial by observers who each watched a different harvest. The soil, slope and seeds never changed. The single fact that explains all five labels is that:

- (A) the field's soil type silently changed in the years it was called commercial
- (B) the label tracks the farmer's purpose each year, which shifted between feeding the family and selling for income
- (C) the field switched between kharif and rabi seasons each year
- (D) subsistence and commercial actually mean the same thing, so any label fits

4. A woman is hired by the day to transplant and weed on a large farm that sells all its rice; she owns no land and keeps no grain. A relative grows flowers and vegetables only, trucking the lot to hotels for cash. Pairing each person with the most accurate description gives:

- (A) the hired woman is a subsistence farmer, and the relative practises subsistence horticulture
- (B) the hired woman is essential farm labour on which agriculture depends, and the relative practises commercial horticulture
- (C) the hired woman is a commercial farmer selling her own crop, and the relative practises cereal commercial farming
- (D) both are outside agriculture because neither grows cereals for a family

5. An official argues, 'Switching every subsistence farm to commercial farming would automatically make families better off.' The most chapter-accurate objection is that:

- (A) commercial farming earns cash but exposes a family to market-price swings and input costs, so a failed price or harvest can leave them worse off than secure home-grown food
- (B) subsistence farming always feeds more people per hectare than commercial farming ever could
- (C) commercial farming is impossible in India because farms are too small to sell anything
- (D) the switch is meaningless because subsistence and commercial farming are the same activity

6. A crop is sown with the first heavy rains of June and harvested as those rains fade into the cool season; it received no canal or well water all season. Its season and most fitting water description are:

- (A) a rabi crop that usually needs winter irrigation
- (B) a kharif crop living mainly on the southwest monsoon
- (C) a zaid crop grown in the short hot gap between seasons
- (D) a kharif crop that depends on canal irrigation rather than rain

7. In a dry-winter belt, a farmer notices her wheat needs canal water every winter while her neighbour's monsoon rice never does. The deepest reason, in cause-and-effect terms, is that:

- (A) wheat dislikes water and irrigation only tricks it into growing
- (B) the belt receives most of its rain during the winter, soaking the wheat
- (C) rice is grown only with canal water while wheat lives on rain
- (D) rice grows in the wet monsoon season when rain supplies its water, while wheat grows in the comparatively dry winter, so it must be watered artificially

8. A farmer near the southeastern coast finds her main rain arrives long after the southwest monsoon has left the rest of the country. She should time her main sowing to the rain that falls around:

- (A) June to September, brought by the southwest monsoon
- (B) March to May, the hot pre-monsoon months
- (C) evenly across all twelve months, so timing does not matter
- (D) October to December, brought by the northeast monsoon

9. Order these from EARLIEST to LATEST sowing within a single farming year that begins right after spring: a wheat crop, a watermelon crop grown in the brief hot gap, and a rice crop sown with the monsoon. The correct earliest-to-latest order is:

- (A) watermelon (zaid), then rice (kharif), then wheat (rabi)
- (B) rice (kharif), then watermelon (zaid), then wheat (rabi)
- (C) wheat (rabi), then rice (kharif), then watermelon (zaid)
- (D) watermelon (zaid), then wheat (rabi), then rice (kharif)

10. Two adjacent fields grow the identical rice variety in the same monsoon. Field 1 sits on deep river silt and Field 2 on thin red soil; Field 1 yields far more with the same seed and effort. The best single explanation is that:

- (A) alluvial silt carried by the river is rich in nutrients and holds moisture, giving the same plants more to draw on than thin red soil
- (B) fertile soil supplies all the plant's needs, so nutrients in the soil are irrelevant
- (C) the higher-yielding soil is really wind-blown desert sand that boosts rice
- (D) river silt clogs the roots, so the silt field should actually yield less

11. A farmer adds well-rotted compost and manure to a tired field, and the next two crops both improve and need watering less often. Which TWO linked effects of humus together explain this?

- (A) humus removes water from the soil and sterilises it, forcing roots to grow
- (B) humus turns loose soil into solid rock that anchors the roots more firmly
- (C) humus adds nutrients and helps the soil hold moisture, so plants are better fed and the soil stays damp longer
- (D) humus raises yields only by killing the soil organisms that competed with the crop

12. A field that grew the same cereal every year saw yields fall. The farmer plants a pulse one season, then the cereal returns and grows better than before. The chain of cause and effect is best described as:

- (A) the pulse physically loosened and spun the soil layers, mixing them for the cereal
- (B) the pulse removed every nutrient at once, which somehow strengthened the cereal
- (C) rotation works only because it lets the field rest empty for a season
- (D) repeating one cereal drained a specific nutrient; the pulse used and returned different nutrients, restoring balance so the next cereal thrived

13. On a steep hillside a farmer cuts the slope into level steps before planting. Compared with leaving the slope bare, the TWO main benefits are best described as:

- (A) the level steps hold rainwater on the slope and slow soil being washed downhill, letting crops grow on steep land
- (B) the steps remove any need for soil and water, so crops grow on bare rock
- (C) the steps turn the fertile hillside into dry desert sand for easier sowing
- (D) the steps let crops grow without seeds by trapping wind-blown plants

14. Two farms grow the same kharif crop the same year. Farm X has only rain; Farm Y has tube wells and a canal. A weak, late monsoon arrives. Then a second farm pair faces a normal monsoon. The combined lesson about irrigation is that:

- (A) irrigation guarantees higher yields than rain-fed farming in every single year regardless of the monsoon
- (B) irrigation mainly protects against monsoon failure, so its advantage over rain-fed farming is largest in weak-monsoon years and smaller in good ones
- (C) irrigation helps only in good-monsoon years, when there is extra rain to pump
- (D) rain-fed farms always beat irrigated farms because rain is free

15. A farmer must choose between saving seed from her own harvest and buying a company's high-yield seed for next year. The most balanced reasoning, true to the chapter, weighs that:

- (A) saved seed always out-yields every modern seed in every field, so buying is never worthwhile
- (B) bought seed is free and never needs extra water or chemicals, so it is always the better choice

- (C) the two seed types behave identically, so the decision changes nothing at all
- (D) saved seed is cheap and adapted to local conditions, while bought high-yield seed can lift yields but costs money and usually demands more water and chemicals, so the right choice depends on her resources

16. A village builds low earthen bunds across its sloping fields and revives an old tank, alongside a new tube well. A visitor concludes Indian farmers only learned water management after modern pumps arrived. The best correction is that:

- (A) managing water became necessary only after the Green Revolution introduced tube wells
- (B) the old tank and bunds show water management is a long-standing concern that farmers met with traditional methods well before, and now alongside, modern pumps
- (C) the bunds and tank prove farmers historically ignored water and relied on rain alone
- (D) such structures matter only in places that never receive any rain

17. A region that led the Green Revolution today reports record past grain output but now tired soil, sinking water tables and farmers deep in loan debt. A student says the high output and the troubles are 'two unrelated coincidences.' The sharper analysis is that:

- (A) the troubles arose only because the region later abandoned the Green Revolution methods
- (B) the debt came from low yields, not from the cost of the seeds, chemicals and pumping
- (C) the same intensive package of heavy seeds, chemicals and pumping that drove the high output also degraded the soil, drew down groundwater and ran up costs, so the gains and the harms share one cause
- (D) the soil and water problems are real but have nothing to do with how the land was farmed

18. Assertion: Years of intensive Green-Revolution farming in a belt raised grain output. Reason: The heavy chemicals and pumping that raised output had no lasting effect on soil or groundwater. Which judgement is correct?

- (A) the assertion is true but the reason is false, because the very inputs that raised output also degraded soil and drew down groundwater over time
- (B) both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason explains the assertion
- (C) both the assertion and the reason are false
- (D) the assertion is false but the reason is true

19. A farmer shifts a chemical-heavy field toward compost, neem sprays and lighter irrigation. After several years the local well water is cleaner and the soil more crumbly. The best causal account is that:

- (A) organic farming uses no water and needs no soil, which is why the well recovered
- (B) the natural inputs magically refilled the aquifer and reformed the soil overnight

- (C) cutting chemical inputs reduced the pollutants washing into the groundwater, and adding organic matter rebuilt soil structure, so both improved over time
- (D) the well and soil improved by chance, unrelated to the change in farming

20. A teacher claims, 'Organic and natural farming are simply the ancient way people always farmed, with no modern thinking behind them.' The chapter's more precise view is that:

- (A) organic methods were invented in the 1960s at the same time as the chemicals
- (B) farming before the Green Revolution always relied on heavy chemical fertilisers
- (C) natural inputs like manure and neem were unknown until very recently
- (D) today's organic and natural farming are a deliberate modern response to the harms the Green Revolution's chemicals caused, even though they revive older natural inputs

21. A farmer fears that switching fully to organic methods overnight will crash her income for a few years while her soil recovers. The most chapter-consistent path is to:

- (A) double her chemical use during the change to be safe against a yield drop
- (B) stop farming entirely until organic produce fetches a higher price
- (C) ignore soil health and chase the maximum possible yield every single year
- (D) blend natural methods with a careful, modest use of some modern inputs during the transition, balancing yield, soil health and cost

22. Rooftop trays in a city grow lettuce in nutrient-rich water with no soil at all, while a hill village cuts terraces and a peri-urban plot raises only flowers and vegetables for sale. Matching each to its name gives:

- (A) the rooftop trays are horticulture, the hill steps are hydroponics, and the flower plot is terrace farming
- (B) the rooftop trays are hydroponics, the hill steps are terrace farming, and the flower-and-vegetable plot is horticulture
- (C) all three are simply commercial farming, with no further distinct names
- (D) the rooftop trays are terrace farming, the hill steps are horticulture, and the flower plot is hydroponics

23. A national survey records who physically sows, transplants, weeds and harvests on small farms, but a separate wage register lists mostly men as 'farm workers.' Read together, the two best support the conclusion that:

- (A) women do very little real farm work, which is why they rarely appear in wage records
- (B) only the paid male labour counts as genuine farming
- (C) women do much of the actual field work, but because a large share is unpaid family labour it is undercounted in wage records
- (D) modern Indian farming needs almost no human labour, so both records are irrelevant

24. A new scheme offers tractors, credit and training to 'the farmer,' picturing him as a man who owns land. Given who actually does the field work, the scheme's likely flaw is that it:

- (A) channels support away from the women and landless labourers who perform much of the real work, so the aid misses the people who would use it
- (B) wastes money because women contribute nothing to farming and need no help
- (C) is fine, since all real farmers are in fact wealthy male landowners
- (D) is pointless because farm labour is no longer needed anywhere in India

25. A small farmer owns a single hectare split into four scattered patches by inheritance. A dealer urges him to buy a large tractor. The most balanced, chapter-consistent advice is that:

- (A) a large tractor is equally cheap and easy on any farm regardless of size or layout
- (B) tractors cannot be used anywhere in Indian farming, so he should refuse outright
- (C) buying the tractor will by itself guarantee he becomes wealthy
- (D) a large tractor suits big consolidated holdings; on his small, fragmented plots it may be costly and hard to use, so it may not pay off

26. A farmer reaps a bumper harvest, yet earns little because prices crash when everyone sells at once; the next year erratic heat and shifting rains wreck his sowing plan; the year after, his inherited land has been split so small that no machine fits. These three years illustrate, in order, the challenges of:

- (A) a weak monsoon, then debt, then soil that grew too fertile
- (B) uncertain market prices, then climate change, then shrinking and fragmented landholdings
- (C) climate change, then uncertain prices, then a total lack of buyers
- (D) fragmented holdings, then a weak monsoon, then perfect prices

27. Evidence of rice cultivation in the Ganga plain in the 7th-8th millennium BCE, barley at Mehrgarh, farming manuals in old texts, and farms still worked today are placed side by side. Together they most strongly support which single conclusion?

- (A) Indian agriculture is a modern practice only a few decades old
- (B) India borrowed all of its farming knowledge from other lands
- (C) Indian agriculture is an ancient tradition that has continued unbroken into the present
- (D) farming flourished in ancient India but was later abandoned and revived only recently

28. A planner says, 'Because India has many soil types, we should pick the single best soil and grow that crop everywhere.' The chapter-grounded flaw is that:

- (A) India in fact has only one soil type, so the plan is impossible from the start
- (B) soil type makes no difference to which crops grow, so the plan is harmless

- (C) different crops suit different soils and climates, so the strength of Indian farming is matching each crop to local conditions, not forcing one crop and soil everywhere
- (D) only a single crop can grow anywhere in India regardless of soil

29. Rice raised in flooded monsoon paddies, wheat sown in the cool dry winter, and a quick watermelon grown in the brief hot gap are, respectively, classic examples of:

- (A) a rabi crop, a kharif crop, and a zaid crop
- (B) a kharif crop, a zaid crop, and a rabi crop
- (C) a zaid crop, a rabi crop, and a kharif crop
- (D) a kharif crop, a rabi crop, and a zaid crop

30. A student summarises the chapter as: 'The Green Revolution was purely beneficial, the typical farmer is a man relying only on modern chemicals, and all Indian farming is the same.' The fully corrected statement is that:

- (A) the Green Revolution had only benefits, farmers are all men using chemicals, and farming is identical everywhere
- (B) the Green Revolution had mixed effects, most rural field work is done by women, many farmers blend traditional and modern methods, and Indian farming varies widely by soil, season, water and purpose
- (C) the Green Revolution failed completely, women do no farm work, and farming never varies
- (D) the Green Revolution is irrelevant, machines do all the work, and soil never matters

31. A farmer must place a single drip-irrigation grant on one of his crops to do the most good: monsoon rice in the rainy season, winter wheat in a dry-winter belt, or a hot-gap melon in fierce summer heat. To best protect against water shortage, he should put it on:

- (A) the monsoon rice, because crops in the rainy season most need extra water
- (B) all three equally, because every crop needs the same water in every season
- (C) the winter wheat or the summer melon, because both grow in dry seasons when little rain falls, whereas the monsoon rice already has the rains
- (D) none of them, because drip irrigation cannot help any field crop

32. A pamphlet states, 'A pesticide is a special water that helps thirsty crops drink during a heatwave.' Using the meaning of the ending '-cide,' the correct statement is that a pesticide:

- (A) is a kind of water for crops, because '-cide' means 'water'
- (B) is a substance that kills crop pests, because '-cide' means 'killer'
- (C) is a high-yield seed, because '-cide' means 'seed'
- (D) is a fenced garden, because '-cide' means 'garden'

33. A claim states, 'Since some city farms now grow lettuce with no soil, soil is useless and ordinary field crops would do better without it.' The accurate correction is that:

- (A) the claim is right, because plants never actually benefit from soil
- (B) hydroponics shows soil is not strictly required because nutrients can be supplied directly in water, but it does not make soil useless, since most field crops still rely on fertile soil
- (C) hydroponics proves plants need no nutrients of any kind to grow
- (D) the claim is wrong because plants can in fact grow only in soil and never in water

34. A farmer grows a high-yield modern rice that needs heavy watering and chemical fertiliser, on a small rain-fed plot in a drought-prone, dry region, with no irrigation and little cash. The chapter would most likely warn that this choice:

- (A) mismatches the seed to her conditions, since a thirsty, input-hungry variety on a dry, cash-poor, rain-fed plot may fail or sink her into debt
- (B) is ideal, because high-yield seed always outperforms saved seed in every setting
- (C) is fine, because modern seed needs no extra water or money once bought
- (D) guarantees a record harvest regardless of water or money, since the seed is modern

35. A district doubles its grain output in a decade using the full Green-Revolution package, then over the next two decades sees soil fertility, water tables and farm incomes all decline. Weighing the whole record, the chapter's lesson about boosting yields with chemicals is best stated as:

- (A) such methods bring only benefits, so the later decline must have a separate cause
- (B) such methods bring only costs, so the early doubling of output never really happened
- (C) such methods have no connection at all to the state of soil, water or income
- (D) such methods can bring real short-term gains in output but impose long-term costs on soil, water and health, so the benefit and the harm must be judged together

36. Three growers face pests. Grower 1 sprays a synthetic chemical pesticide; Grower 2 uses a neem-based spray; Grower 3 lets the pests run unchecked. Which grower's choice best matches organic farming, and why?

- (A) Grower 1, because organic farming relies on strong chemical sprays
- (B) Grower 3, because organic farming means abandoning pest control entirely
- (C) all three equally, because the method of pest control does not affect the label
- (D) Grower 2, because organic farming replaces chemical pesticides with natural pest controls like neem rather than abandoning pest control

37. A definition reads: 'farming that meets today's food needs while keeping the soil, water and farming itself healthy enough for future generations to keep farming.' This best defines:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-----------------------|
| (A) sustainable farming | (B) extensive farming |
| (C) commercial farming | (D) intensive farming |

38. A village wants to keep its soil productive for decades. Which combined programme best matches what the chapter calls soil conservation?

- (A) growing the same nutrient-hungry crop every year and pumping more groundwater
- (B) rotating crops, adding humus through compost and manure, and building bunds to stop erosion
- (C) applying the maximum dose of chemical fertiliser to every field each season
- (D) exporting the village's topsoil to enrich other farms

39. A teacher draws the 'typical Indian farmer' as a single man on a tractor and says machines now do all the work. Two separate corrections from the chapter apply. They are that:

- (A) tractors are never used anywhere in India, and only men ever farm
- (B) Indian farming is not fully mechanised, and women do most of the hands-on field work, so a woman is at least as representative as the man pictured
- (C) machines truly do all the work now, so no person represents the farmer
- (D) women own most of the farmland, which is why they alone drive the tractors

40. A field on flat fertile silt, well served by a canal, is to be sown with a winter crop. Which single combination of labels could ALL truly apply to this field in that season?

- (A) rabi, irrigated, and alluvial-soil farming
- (B) kharif, rain-fed, and alluvial-soil farming
- (C) zaid, irrigated, and desert-sand farming
- (D) rabi, rain-fed, and black-soil farming

41. A farmer reasons, 'My plot is very small, so by definition I must be a subsistence farmer; and because I work it hard, that makes it commercial.' Both halves are mistaken because:

- (A) small plots are always commercial and hard work always makes a farm subsistence
- (B) subsistence and commercial are decided by the soil type, not by purpose
- (C) plot size and effort do not set the subsistence/commercial label, which depends only on whether the crop is grown to eat or to sell
- (D) the labels are fixed by the cropping season, kharif being commercial and rabi subsistence

42. A region's main rains come in October-December and barely receives the June-September rains. A farmer there plants her major crop in June to 'catch the monsoon early.' The likely result and reason are that:

- (A) the crop will thrive, because the southwest monsoon soaks every part of India equally in June
- (B) the crop will thrive, because all regions get their heaviest rain in June regardless of location

- (C) the crop will struggle for water, because this region's main rains come with the northeast monsoon in October-December, not the June southwest monsoon
- (D) the timing makes no difference, because rainfall is spread evenly through the year everywhere

43. A farmer's notebook says: 'Sown June, lived on rain, harvested October.' For the next crop she writes: 'Sown November, watered by canal, harvested March.' The two crops are best classified, in order, as:

- (A) a rain-fed kharif crop, then an irrigated rabi crop
- (B) an irrigated rabi crop, then a rain-fed kharif crop
- (C) a zaid crop, then a kharif crop
- (D) two kharif crops grown back to back

44. A factory owner says, 'Agriculture means only growing cereal grains; orchards, fish ponds and beehives are something else entirely.' The chapter's broader definition corrects this because agriculture includes:

- (A) only cereals such as wheat and rice, exactly as the owner says
- (B) banking, insurance and the printing of money
- (C) crops together with related work like horticulture, forestry, fisheries and beekeeping, not cereals alone
- (D) the building of roads, bridges and factories

45. A country imports most of its food, then over a decade adopts high-yield seeds, irrigation and chemicals and begins growing enough grain to feed itself. The most important national-scale result described for India's Green Revolution that this mirrors is that the country:

- (A) no longer needed any water for its crops
- (B) made every one of its farmers permanently wealthy
- (C) became largely self-sufficient in food grains instead of depending on imports
- (D) abandoned farming and shifted entirely to industry

46. Three statements about cropping seasons are offered. Exactly one is FALSE. Which is it?

- (A) Kharif crops are sown with the arriving southwest monsoon in the hot, rainy season
- (B) Rabi crops grow in the cool winter with less rain and are harvested in spring
- (C) Zaid crops are short crops grown in the hot gap between rabi and kharif
- (D) Rabi is the monsoon season's main crop, sown in June and living on heavy rain

47. A policymaker wants the single most direct way to cut crop failures in years when the monsoon arrives late and weak. From the chapter, the best lever is to:

- (A) order every farm to depend more heavily on rainfall alone
- (B) ban kharif crops so farming happens only in the winter

- (C) expand irrigation such as canals, wells and drip systems so crops get water even when the monsoon fails
- (D) require every field to grow one single crop every year

48. A grower keeps almost all her harvest to feed her family, works her one hectare with intense labour and well water, and in one unusually good year barter a small surplus with a neighbour. The best classification of her farming overall is:

- (A) commercial, because she exchanged a surplus in one good year
- (B) subsistence and intensive and irrigated, since her purpose remains feeding the household despite one tiny barter
- (C) extensive, because she has only one hectare
- (D) horticulture, simply because she grows food

49. A campaign slogan reads, 'Real progress means turning every Indian farm into a fully mechanised, chemical-fed, single-crop commercial operation.' Drawing on the chapter's full argument, the strongest single objection is that:

- (A) there is no objection, because chemical single-crop commercial farming is best for every farm
- (B) the only problem is that machines are simply too expensive to buy
- (C) the slogan fails only because India lacks any commercial farms at all
- (D) such uniformity ignores varied soils, seasons and family needs, repeats the Green Revolution's soil, water and debt harms, and sidelines the women and small farmers who sustain agriculture

50. A farmer notices her well water dropping a little more each year as she pumps harder for an irrigation-heavy crop, while her neighbour with a rain-fed crop sees no such drop. The most accurate reading is that:

- (A) heavy pumping raises the water table, so her falling well must be a measurement error
- (B) groundwater is endless, so pumping can never lower a well
- (C) her continual heavy pumping is drawing down the shared groundwater faster than it refills, a risk to future water supply that rain-fed farming avoids
- (D) the neighbour's rain-fed crop is secretly draining the well instead

51. A trader claims, 'Traditional saved-seed, low-chemical farming always produces more total food than the Green-Revolution package ever could.' The most accurate correction is that:

- (A) the Green Revolution sharply raised food-grain output and helped India feed itself, even though it caused serious long-term harms, so the blanket claim is wrong
- (B) the claim is right, because saved seed always out-produces high-yield seed
- (C) the Green Revolution actually lowered India's total food output
- (D) neither approach affects how much food is produced

52. A farmer wants to lower her costs and protect her soil yet not lose all her yield. The chapter would most endorse which approach as the wise middle path?

- (A) combining saved local seed and compost with a careful, modest use of some modern inputs
- (B) relying entirely on the heaviest chemical fertiliser and pesticide doses available
- (C) abandoning all inputs and tools and hoping the crop grows on its own
- (D) buying the most expensive high-yield seed and irrigating as much as possible

53. A district's farm survey shows women doing most sowing, weeding and harvesting, yet the same district's training budget reaches almost only male landowners. The most reasonable policy conclusion is that:

- (A) the budget is well aimed, since women do little of the real farm work
- (B) support should be withdrawn from any farm where women work
- (C) training, tools and credit should be redirected toward the women and landless labourers who actually perform most of the work
- (D) imported labour should replace the women so training can stay with men

54. A farmer faces a hillside plot, sloping and prone to soil washing away in heavy rain, and wants both to grow crops and to slow erosion. The single technique the chapter most directly recommends is:

- (A) hydroponics, growing the hillside crops in nutrient water without any soil
- (B) terrace farming, cutting the slope into level steps that hold rainwater and check soil loss
- (C) the Green Revolution package of high-yield seed and chemicals
- (D) switching the whole plot to commercial export horticulture

55. Comparing an organic wheat field and a chemical-intensive wheat field standing side by side, all four statements below are tempting, but only one is the clearest TRUE difference. It is that the organic field:

- (A) produces no wheat at all, unlike the chemical field
- (B) avoids synthetic fertilisers and pesticides in favour of natural inputs like compost, manure and neem
- (C) grows its wheat entirely without any soil
- (D) actually uses more chemical pesticide than the chemical-intensive field

56. A village elder recalls that long before any company seed or chemical existed, farmers there carefully chose, dried and stored seed from each year's best plants. The chief value of these saved traditional seeds, as the chapter frames it, is that they:

- (A) are low-cost and adapted over generations to the local soil and climate, even if they do not always give the highest possible yield
- (B) always give the single highest yield of any seed available anywhere

- (C) can be used only once in history and then never again
- (D) require heavy chemicals and abundant irrigation to grow at all

57. A farmer divides his already small land equally among his four children, each of whom later does the same. Tracing this over two generations, the chief effect on farming is that:

- (A) each farm grows larger over time, making big machines essential
- (B) the soil on every patch becomes more fertile with each division
- (C) the market price of the crop rises automatically as plots shrink
- (D) holdings shrink and become fragmented into tiny scattered patches, making efficient farming and machinery use harder

58. A planner wants to name the cluster of genuine, present-day pressures on Indian farmers, leaving out any false 'problem.' Which set is entirely correct?

- (A) too much land, perfect guaranteed prices, and no climate of any kind
- (B) soil that is always too fertile, an excess of irrigation everywhere, and no buyers at all
- (C) a complete absence of any difficulty, since modern farming has solved every problem
- (D) shrinking and fragmented landholdings, climate change, uncertain market prices, water stress and debt

59. A class debates why the chapter calls women's field work the 'backbone' of rural farming. The strongest, most accurate reason is that women:

- (A) own most of the country's farmland
- (B) alone operate all the heavy farm machinery
- (C) manage farms only from offices and never enter the fields
- (D) perform the bulk of the hands-on tasks such as sowing, transplanting, weeding and harvesting that keep farms running

60. A single sentence is to capture the chapter's corrected, threads-together picture of Indian farming. The best one is that:

- (A) Indian farming is an ancient, varied tradition where most field work is done by women, the Green Revolution brought mixed results, and wise farmers blend traditional and modern methods to balance yield, soil and cost
- (B) Indian farming is a recent, uniform activity done mainly by men using only chemicals, with the Green Revolution a pure success
- (C) Indian farming never changed since ancient times, machines now do everything, and soil and season make no difference
- (D) Indian farming is purely commercial and irrigated everywhere, women play no part, and saved seeds are worthless

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 13: The Story of Indian Farming — Paper 5

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	C	21	D	31	C	41	C	51	A
2	A	12	D	22	B	32	B	42	C	52	A
3	B	13	A	23	C	33	B	43	A	53	C
4	B	14	B	24	A	34	A	44	C	54	B
5	A	15	D	25	D	35	D	45	C	55	B
6	B	16	B	26	B	36	D	46	D	56	A
7	D	17	C	27	C	37	A	47	C	57	D
8	D	18	A	28	C	38	B	48	B	58	D
9	A	19	C	29	D	39	B	49	D	59	D
10	A	20	D	30	B	40	A	50	C	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (C) The three terms answer three separate questions and all hold together. Effort per unit of land is high (much labour and water on one hectare), so she farms intensively; her purpose is to feed the family rather than to sell, so it is subsistence; and she waters artificially from a tube well, so it is irrigated. The option limiting her to one label is wrong because the axes are independent and stack. Treating purpose as the only valid axis ignores the effort and water descriptions, which are equally real. Saying no label applies because she sells nothing confuses subsistence (a recognised category) with being outside farming.

2. (A) A applies thin effort over much land (extensive) and sells the grain (commercial); B concentrates effort on a small plot (intensive) and eats the harvest (subsistence). The option swapping the effort labels reverses high-versus-low effort per area. The option swapping the purpose labels gives the seller subsistence and the eater commercial, which inverts who sells. Calling both commercial ignores that B sells nothing, and merely producing a crop never settles purpose.

3. (B) Subsistence versus commercial is decided by purpose, and purpose can change year to year while the land stays identical, which fits a sequence of mixed labels. Invoking a changing soil type contradicts the statement that soil never changed and confuses soil with purpose. The season axis (kharif/rabi) is separate from purpose and would not flip the subsistence/commercial label. Claiming the two terms are identical is false, since one means growing to eat and the other to sell.

4. (B) The day-labourer supplies the hired labour Indian agriculture leans on, and the flower-and-vegetable seller grows horticultural crops for the market, which is commercial horticulture. Calling the labourer a subsistence farmer is wrong because she keeps no crop and feeds no household from it, and the relative sells, so she is not subsistence either. Calling the labourer a commercial farmer is wrong because she owns no crop to sell, and the relative grows no cereals. Treating both as outside agriculture ignores that labour and horticulture are squarely inside farming.

5. (A) Commercial farming brings income but also market risk and input costs, so guaranteed family food can be safer than cash crops that fail or fetch a collapsed price. Claiming subsistence always out-feeds commercial per hectare is an unsupported blanket reversal. Saying commercial farming is impossible on small farms contradicts the many small commercial growers in the chapter. Treating the two as the same activity erases the purpose distinction the argument turns on.

6. (B) Sowing with June rains and harvesting as the monsoon ends marks the kharif (monsoon) season, and getting no canal or well water means it lived on the southwest monsoon. Rabi is the cool-season winter crop, sown later and often irrigated, which the June timing rules out. Zaid is the brief summer crop between rabi and kharif, not one sown with the monsoon's onset. The final option contradicts the stated fact that no canal water was used.

7. (D) The timing of each crop relative to the rains explains it: kharif rice sits in the rainy monsoon and drinks rain, while rabi wheat sits in the dry winter and must be irrigated. The idea that wheat dislikes water is false, since wheat needs water and simply has little rain in winter. Claiming the belt's rain falls in winter contradicts a dry-winter belt where the monsoon comes in summer. Saying rice needs canal water reverses which crop is rain-fed.

8. (D) The southeastern coast is watered chiefly by the retreating northeast monsoon of October to December, which is exactly the late rain described. June to September is the southwest monsoon that soaks most of India but largely misses this belt's main season. March to May is the dry hot season before any monsoon. Rainfall in India is strongly seasonal, never spread evenly through the year, so timing is decisive.

9. (A) Starting just after spring, the short hot gap (zaid, e.g. watermelon) comes first, then the monsoon crop (kharif rice) sown in June, then the cool-season crop (rabi wheat) sown

in winter. Putting kharif before zaid skips the early-summer gap that opens right after spring. Leading with rabi places the winter crop before the summer and monsoon crops, which is out of sequence for a year beginning after spring. Putting rabi before kharif reverses winter and monsoon sowing.

10. (A) Alluvial silt is nutrient-rich and moisture-retentive, so identical plants do better on it than on thin red soil, which fits Field 1 out-yielding Field 2. Saying nutrients are irrelevant is self-contradictory, since it is the soil's nutrients that drive the difference. Calling fertile silt desert sand confuses a rich river deposit with barren wind-blown sand. Claiming silt clogs roots predicts the opposite of the observed higher yield.

11. (C) Humus enriches the soil with nutrients and improves moisture retention, which explains both the better crop and the reduced need to water. Saying humus removes water contradicts the observed lower watering need. Turning soil to rock would harm, not help, root growth and yield. Crediting the gain to killing soil organisms misstates humus, which supports rather than destroys the living soil that crops rely on.

12. (D) Different crops draw on and return different nutrients, so a pulse rotated in repairs the imbalance left by a single repeated cereal, and the next cereal grows better. 'Spinning' the soil literally is a misreading of crop rotation, which is about alternating crops, not stirring earth. Removing every nutrient at once would weaken, not strengthen, the next crop. The field was not left empty; a pulse was grown, so 'resting empty' is not the mechanism.

13. (A) Terracing creates flat steps that retain rainwater and check erosion, making steep ground farmable. Removing the need for soil and water describes nothing terracing does, since crops still need both. Turning a hillside into desert sand is a loss of fertility, the opposite of the goal. Crops never grow without seeds, so the wind-blown-plant option is nonsense.

14. (B) Irrigation's chief value is supplying water when the monsoon fails, so its edge is greatest in a weak year and narrows when rain is ample. Claiming it always wins every year overstates the case, since in a good monsoon a rain-fed farm may do nearly as well. Saying it helps only in good years inverts the logic, as pumps do not need rain to run and matter most in shortfalls. The claim that rain-fed always wins ignores that free rain is useless when it does not fall.

15. (D) The honest trade-off is cheap, locally adapted saved seed versus costlier high-yield seed that raises output but needs more water and chemicals, so the answer turns on her means. Claiming saved seed always wins ignores the real yield gains modern seed can bring. Saying bought seed is free and input-free is factually wrong. Treating the two as identical erases the cost-and-input differences the choice hinges on.

16. (B) Tanks and bunds are old indigenous techniques, so their presence shows water management predates and now coexists with modern pumps. Saying it began with the Green Revolution ignores the antiquity of those very structures. Claiming the structures prove farmers ignored water is self-contradictory, since the structures exist to manage water. Restricting their use to rainless places misses that they store and direct seasonal rain.

17. (C) The output and the damage flow from one source: the intensive input-heavy methods raised yields while degrading soil, depleting groundwater and piling up costs, so they are causally linked, not coincidental. Blaming abandonment is wrong, since the harms came from continued use, not from stopping. Pinning debt on low yields ignores that yields rose; the debt came from high input costs. Denying any link between farming method and soil-water harm contradicts the whole cause-and-effect chain.

18. (A) Output did rise, so the assertion is true, but the claim of no lasting effect is false, since the same chemicals and pumping degraded soil and lowered water tables. The option calling both true and linked endorses the false 'no effect' claim. Calling both false denies the real rise in output. Calling the assertion false ignores the documented yield gains.

19. (C) Reducing chemicals lessens the pollutants leaching into groundwater, and organic matter rebuilds soil, so both effects follow the change in practice over years. Saying organic farming uses no water or soil is false, as crops still need both. The improvement is gradual, not an overnight magical refill. Calling it chance ignores the clear cause-and-effect from the changed inputs.

20. (D) The chapter frames organic and natural farming as a conscious modern reaction to chemical harm, even as it draws on older natural inputs, which is why it is a 'response.' Saying organic methods were invented in the 1960s alongside the chemicals confuses the response with the cause. Claiming pre-Green-Revolution farming used heavy chemicals is false, since those chemicals came with the Green Revolution. Saying manure and neem were unknown until recently contradicts their long traditional use.

21. (D) A gradual blend of natural methods with careful modern inputs cushions income while improving soil, which matches the chapter's balanced advice. Doubling chemicals worsens the very harms she is trying to escape. Stopping farming surrenders both food and income and ignores the gradual path. Ignoring soil health and chasing maximum yield reproduces the Green Revolution's long-term damage.

22. (B) Growing plants in nutrient water without soil is hydroponics, cutting a slope into steps is terrace farming, and raising fruits, vegetables and flowers is horticulture. The first wrong option scrambles each term onto the wrong scene. Calling all three merely commercial ignores their distinct techniques and crops. The last option again misassigns every label.

23. (C) The hands-on survey shows women doing most field work, while the wage register misses them because their labour is often unpaid family work, so they are undercounted. Concluding women do little work flips the survey evidence. Saying only paid male labour counts arbitrarily defines away the women's real work. Claiming farming needs almost no labour contradicts the very tasks the survey records.

24. (A) Targeting only male landowners overlooks the women and landless labourers who do much of the work, so the support reaches the wrong hands. Saying women contribute nothing contradicts the chapter's central point. Assuming all farmers are wealthy male landowners is false, since many are women and landless. Claiming farm labour is no longer needed denies the ongoing human work the scheme should support.

25. (D) Mechanisation favours larger, consolidated land; on tiny scattered patches a big tractor is often too costly and awkward to justify. Saying it is equally easy on any farm ignores how size and fragmentation matter. Claiming tractors cannot be used anywhere is false. Guaranteeing wealth from one purchase overstates what a tractor can do.

26. (B) A good harvest fetching little is the market-price problem, erratic heat and rain is climate change, and splitting land too small to mechanise is fragmentation, matching the order given. The first wrong set mislabels the price crash as a weak monsoon and adds an impossible 'too fertile' harm. The second misorders price and climate and invents a total lack of buyers. The third mislabels the climate year as monsoon and ends with 'perfect prices,' which is not a challenge at all.

27. (C) Ancient rice and barley sites, old farming texts, and farms worked today together show a long, continuous tradition. Calling it only decades old ignores the millennia-old evidence. Saying it was all borrowed contradicts the home-grown ancient sites and texts. Claiming it was abandoned and revived is wrong, since the chain runs unbroken to the present.

28. (C) Crops are matched to soils and climates, so the variety of Indian soils is a reason to grow different crops in different places, not to standardise one. Saying India has one soil type contradicts its several major soils. Claiming soil makes no difference denies the link between soil and yield the chapter stresses. Saying only one crop can grow anywhere is false and the opposite of the chapter's point.

29. (D) Monsoon paddy rice is kharif, cool-winter wheat is rabi, and the short hot-gap watermelon is zaid, in that order. The first wrong option swaps rice and wheat between kharif and rabi. The second swaps wheat and watermelon. The third scrambles all three.

30. (B) Each of the student's three errors is reversed in the correct option: mixed Green-Revolution record, women doing most field work, blended methods, and wide regional variation. The first wrong option simply repeats the student's mistakes. The second over-

corrects into the opposite falsehoods. The third invents new errors about machines and soil that the chapter rejects.

31. (C) Drip water is most valuable where natural rain is scarce, so the dry-season wheat and the hot-gap melon gain most, while the monsoon rice already drinks the rains. Putting it on the rice wastes the grant where rain is plentiful. Saying all need equal water ignores that seasons differ sharply in rainfall. Saying drip cannot help any field crop contradicts the chapter's whole point about irrigation.

32. (B) '-cide' means killer, so a pesticide kills pests, not waters crops. The water meaning is invented and contradicts the ending. There is no seed meaning in '-cide.' There is no garden meaning either, so that option is also wrong.

33. (B) Hydroponics proves soil is not strictly necessary when nutrients reach the roots in water, yet most ordinary field crops still depend on fertile soil, so soil is far from useless. Saying plants never benefit from soil is false. Claiming plants need no nutrients misreads hydroponics, which supplies nutrients in the water. Saying plants can grow only in soil is exactly the misconception hydroponics disproves.

34. (A) High-yield seed demands water and chemicals she lacks, so on a dry, cash-poor, rain-fed plot it is likely to fail or push her into debt, a clear mismatch. Saying high-yield seed always wins ignores the conditions it requires. Claiming modern seed needs no water or money is the very misconception the chapter corrects. Guaranteeing a harvest regardless of water or money ignores that the seed's needs are unmet.

35. (D) The record shows genuine early gains followed by long-term harm, so yields and damage are weighed together. Insisting on only benefits forces an invented separate cause for the decline. Insisting on only costs denies the documented doubling of output. Denying any link between chemical methods and soil, water and income contradicts the cause-and-effect the district shows.

36. (D) Organic farming controls pests with natural means such as neem, so Grower 2 fits. Grower 1 uses synthetic chemicals, the very thing organic farming avoids. Grower 3 abandons control, but organic farming still controls pests, just naturally. The method clearly does affect the label, so 'all equally' is wrong.

37. (A) Meeting present needs without harming the future ability to farm is exactly sustainable farming. Extensive farming refers to thin effort over large land, not to long-term resource care. Commercial farming is about selling crops, a purpose, not sustainability. Intensive farming concerns high effort per area, again unrelated to protecting future resources.

38. (B) Soil conservation bundles crop rotation, adding humus, and preventing erosion, which the first option names exactly. Repeating one hungry crop and over-pumping degrades soil and water rather than conserving them. Maxing chemical fertiliser harms

long-term fertility. Exporting topsoil literally removes the resource conservation aims to protect.

39. (B) Two facts correct the picture: farming is not fully mechanised, and women do most field work, so a woman is at least as typical. Saying tractors are never used and only men farm contradicts both reality and the women's role. Claiming machines do all the work denies the human labour the chapter stresses. Saying women own most farmland and drive all tractors misstates the basis of their role, which is hands-on field work, not land ownership.

40. (A) A winter sowing is rabi, a canal supply is irrigated, and river silt is alluvial soil, so all three fit. The kharif/rain-fed option is wrong because a winter crop is not kharif and a canal-served field is not rain-fed. The zaid/desert-sand option mislabels the winter season and calls fertile silt desert sand. The rabi/rain-fed/black-soil option correctly says rabi but wrongly calls a canal-fed field rain-fed and silt soil black soil.

41. (C) Subsistence versus commercial turns on purpose, to eat or to sell, not on plot size or effort, so both halves of his reasoning are confused. The first wrong option just inverts his errors rather than correcting them. Tying the labels to soil type substitutes the wrong axis. Tying them to season likewise uses the wrong axis, since kharif and rabi describe timing, not purpose.

42. (C) Since this belt's main rain is the October-December northeast monsoon, a June sowing misses the water and the crop suffers. Saying the June southwest monsoon soaks everywhere equally ignores that this region largely misses it. Claiming all regions peak in June is false for northeast-monsoon belts. Saying rainfall is even all year contradicts India's sharply seasonal rains.

43. (A) June sowing on rain, harvested as the monsoon ends, is a rain-fed kharif crop; November sowing watered by canal, harvested in spring, is an irrigated rabi crop. The first wrong option reverses the order of the two. Calling the first a zaid crop ignores its monsoon timing. Calling both kharif ignores that the second is a canal-watered winter crop.

44. (C) The chapter defines agriculture broadly to take in horticulture, forestry, fisheries and beekeeping alongside crops, so orchards, ponds and hives are part of it. Limiting it to cereals repeats the owner's error. Banking and money-printing belong to other sectors entirely. Road and bridge building is construction, not agriculture.

45. (C) The headline gain of the Green Revolution was national food self-sufficiency in grains, ending heavy reliance on imports. Saying crops no longer needed water is false, since the package relied heavily on irrigation. Claiming every farmer became permanently wealthy ignores the debt and harm many faced. Saying the country abandoned farming contradicts the very rise in grain output.

46. (D) Rabi is the cool-season winter crop, not the monsoon crop sown in June, so that statement is the false one. Kharif being sown with the southwest monsoon in the rainy season is true. Rabi growing in winter and harvested in spring is true. Zaid being a short hot-gap crop between rabi and kharif is true.

47. (C) Irrigation supplies water when the monsoon fails, so expanding it most directly reduces weak-monsoon crop failures. Pushing more dependence on rainfall worsens the problem. Banning kharif crops removes the main monsoon harvest without solving water shortage. Forcing one crop everywhere ignores soil and season variation and does nothing for water security.

48. (B) Her ongoing purpose is to feed the family, so she is subsistence; she works the plot intensively and waters it, so intensive and irrigated also fit, and one tiny barter does not make her commercial. A single exchange does not flip the dominant purpose to commercial. Having one hectare does not make her extensive, since she works it intensively. Growing food is not horticulture, which means fruits, vegetables and flowers.

49. (D) The chapter's whole case is that farming rightly varies with soil, season and need, that heavy chemical monocropping degrades soil and water and creates debt, and that women and small farmers matter, so forced uniformity is the deep flaw. Saying there is no objection endorses the very approach the chapter critiques. Reducing the problem to machine cost ignores the soil, water, debt and labour issues. Saying India lacks commercial farms is false and misses the point.

50. (C) Sustained heavy pumping can outpace recharge and lower the water table, threatening future supply, while a rain-fed plot does not pump. Saying pumping raises the table inverts the cause. Treating groundwater as endless ignores that wells do run low. Blaming the rain-fed neighbour, who pumps nothing, misassigns the cause.

51. (A) The Green Revolution clearly raised grain output and aided self-sufficiency, so the claim that traditional methods always produce more is false, even granting the real harms. Saying saved seed always out-produces high-yield seed ignores the documented gains. Claiming the Green Revolution lowered output reverses the record. Saying neither approach affects output is plainly false.

52. (A) Blending saved seed and compost with careful modern inputs balances yield, soil health and cost, which the chapter favours. Maximum chemicals raise cost and harm soil, the opposite of her goal. Abandoning all inputs risks losing the yield she wants to keep. Buying costly seed and maximising irrigation drives up cost and water use, against her aims.

53. (C) Since women do most of the work, directing support to them and to landless labourers matches aid to the people who use it. Calling the budget well aimed contradicts the survey showing women do most work. Withdrawing support from farms with women

punishes the main workers. Replacing women with imported labour ignores both the survey and the real labour force.

54. (B) Terracing turns a steep slope into level steps that retain water and reduce erosion while allowing crops, exactly the need described. Hydroponics addresses growing without soil, not stabilising a slope. The Green Revolution package concerns yield-boosting inputs, not erosion control. Export horticulture is about what and why to grow, not about holding soil on a slope.

55. (B) Organic farming's defining feature is replacing synthetic fertilisers and pesticides with natural inputs, the clear true difference. Saying it produces no wheat is false, since organic farms do grow food. Growing without soil describes hydroponics, not organic field farming. Saying the organic field uses more chemical pesticide reverses its whole definition.

56. (A) Saved seeds are prized for being cheap and locally adapted, though not necessarily the highest yielding. Claiming they always give the highest yield overstates them, since high-yield modern seed can out-produce them. Saying they can be used only once contradicts their being saved and replanted yearly. Saying they need heavy chemicals and irrigation describes high-yield seed, not adapted saved seed.

57. (D) Repeated division shrinks and fragments holdings into small scattered patches, which hampers efficiency and machinery, a key present-day challenge. Saying farms grow larger reverses what division does. Dividing land does not improve soil fertility. Smaller plots do not automatically raise crop prices.

58. (D) Fragmented holdings, climate change, uncertain prices, water stress and debt are the real pressures the chapter lists. Abundant land and guaranteed perfect prices are not problems and are false. Soil being too fertile and irrigation everywhere are not the chapter's challenges. Claiming no difficulties exist contradicts the whole final section on challenges.

59. (D) Women are the backbone because they do most of the hands-on field tasks that keep farms running. Owning most farmland is not the basis of the claim, which is about labour, not ownership. Saying they alone run all machinery misstates their role and ignores the chapter's point about limited mechanisation. Saying they manage only from offices contradicts their hands-on field work.

60. (A) The correct sentence weaves the chapter's key threads: ancient and varied tradition, women doing most work, mixed Green-Revolution record, and blended methods. The first wrong option restates every misconception the chapter dismantles. The second denies change, overstates machines and dismisses soil and season. The third falsely makes farming uniformly commercial, erases women and dismisses saved seed.